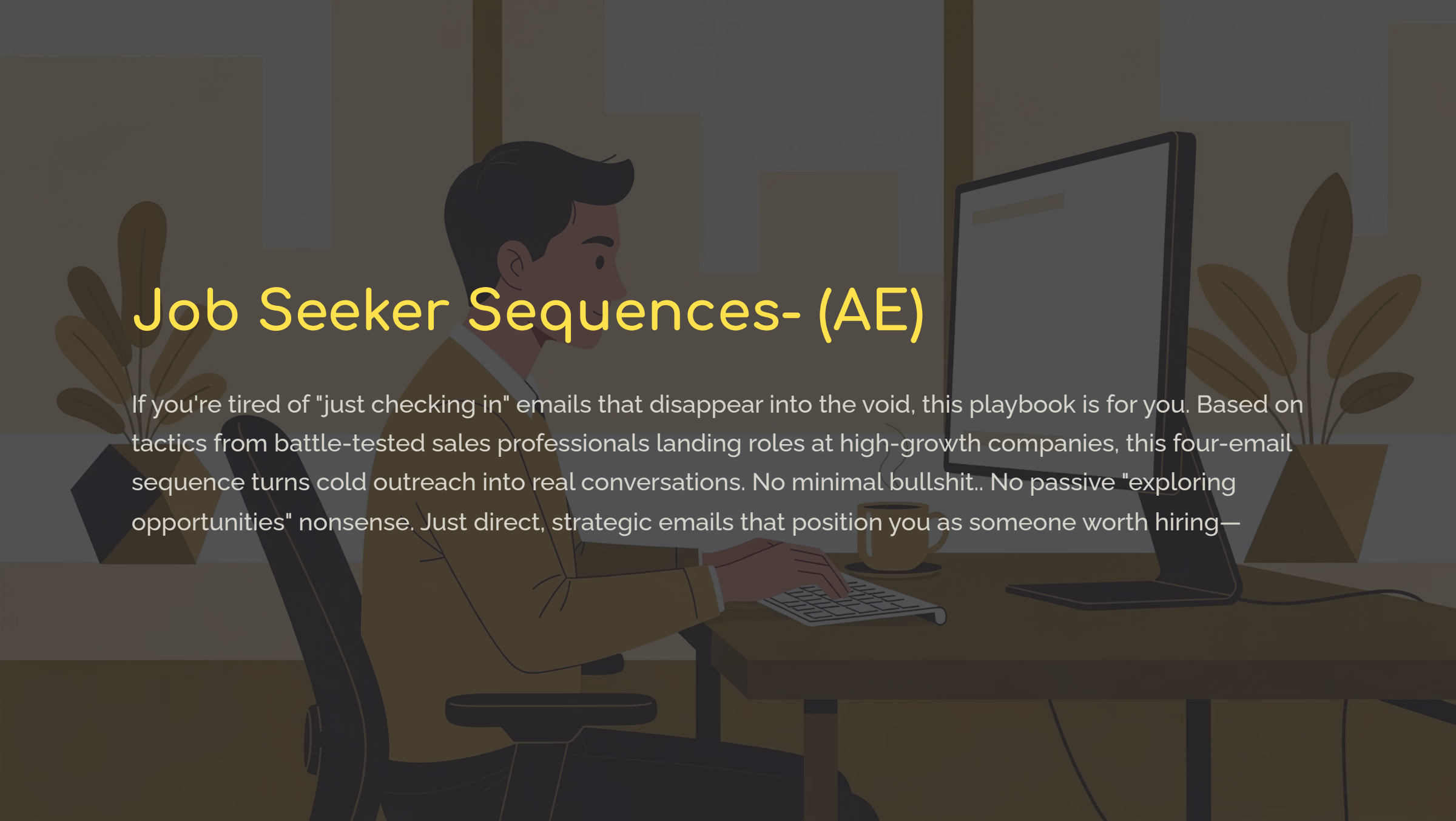


An illustration of a man with dark hair, wearing a brown jacket, sitting at a wooden desk. He is looking at a large computer monitor and has his hands on a keyboard. On the desk, there is also a small brown mug with steam rising from it. Two potted plants with large, dark leaves are on the desk, one on each side of the man. The background is a dark, stylized cityscape with rectangular shapes representing buildings.

Job Seeker Sequences- (AE)

If you're tired of "just checking in" emails that disappear into the void, this playbook is for you. Based on tactics from battle-tested sales professionals landing roles at high-growth companies, this four-email sequence turns cold outreach into real conversations. No minimal bullshit.. No passive "exploring opportunities" nonsense. Just direct, strategic emails that position you as someone worth hiring—

Why Most Job Seeker Emails Fail

The Problem

Your competition is sending the same boring emails. "I'm interested in opportunities at your company" gets deleted in 2 seconds. You sound like every other candidate begging for attention.

Sales leaders can smell generic outreach from a mile away. They delete it faster than they delete vendor spam.

The Solution

This sequence flips the script. You're not asking for a job—you're demonstrating you already think like someone on their team. You're showing research, internal validation, and specific value before they even open your resume.

You control the narrative instead of waiting for HR to call you back.

The difference between getting ignored and getting hired often comes down to these four emails. Most job seekers give up after one message. The ones who win? They execute a sequence that builds credibility with every touchpoint.

The 4-Email



Email 1: Research Hook

Show you've done homework. Reference specific content. Make philosophical connection. Ask for 15 minutes.

Timing: Day 1

Attachment: None



Email 2: Internal Validation

Name-drop current team member. Reference specific challenges. Show how you've solved similar problems.

Timing: 3-5 days later

Attachment: Resume



Email 3: Brag Book

Lower pressure. Demonstrate market knowledge. Position as pipeline play, not immediate hire.

Timing: 5-7 days later

Attachment: Brag Book



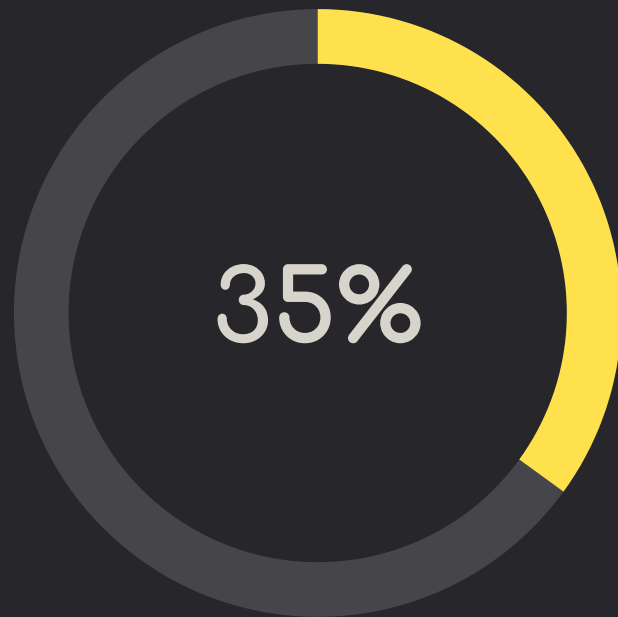
Email 4: Graceful Persistence

Acknowledge timing might be off. Express genuine enthusiasm. Keep door open without being pushy.

Timing: 7-10 days later

Attachment: None

Success Metrics That Matter



Open Rate Target

Email 1 should hit 30-40% open rate. If you're below 20%, your subject lines suck.



Response Rate Target

By Email 3, you should see 15-25% response rate. This is significantly higher than typical cold outreach.



Maximum Touches

Stop at 4 emails. After that, move to quarterly check-ins. Anything more is spam territory.

Track every email like it's a sales pipeline—because it is one. Keep a spreadsheet with contact name, company, email dates, responses, and next actions. If you're not measuring, you're just throwing spaghetti at the wall and hoping something sticks.

Email 1: The Research Hook

Subject: BDR → VP Journey + Extreme Ownership

Hey Mike,

Saw "Extreme Ownership" leading your LinkedIn headline. Not a lot of VPs put that front and center - usually it's just "results-driven" or some other LinkedIn-speak. Tells me a lot about how you run teams.

Started as a BDR at [Company], carried bag for 3 years, now running a team of 8. Hit 127% of team quota last year in a market where most orgs were at 80%.

What caught my attention about you specifically: You started as a BDR, you built ThreadHeart to \$100K in 9 months, and you've publicly talked about personalizing quotas instead of the cookie-cutter approach. That's not typical VP thinking.

Not sure if you're hiring or if there's a fit, but I'd love 15 minutes to talk about what you're building at Everstage and how you think about bringing people onto your team.

Best, [Your Name]

Email 1 Breakdown: What Makes This Work

Specific Research

"Extreme Ownership" in the headline isn't random. It shows you actually looked at their profile instead of copy-pasting a template.

Generic research gets ignored. Specific details get responses.

Philosophical Alignment

You're not just listing accomplishments—you're showing you think the same way they do about leadership and team building.

This creates instant rapport that "I'm a hard worker" never will.

Credibility Without Bragging

127% of quota in a down market speaks for itself. No need to oversell or use adjectives like "passionate" or "enthusiastic."

Let the numbers do the talking.

Critical Rule: Keep this email under 150 words. Sales leaders skim. If they need to scroll to finish reading, you've already lost them. Every sentence should earn its place. Cut ruthlessly.

Email 1 Strategy: Research That Actually Matters

01

Find Their Content

Look for podcasts, LinkedIn posts, company blog articles, interviews. Find what they've said publicly about leadership, sales philosophy, or team building.

02

Identify the Hook

Pick one specific thing that resonates with your experience or values. Not generic praise—something that shows you actually read it and thought about it.

03

Connect Your Journey

Draw a parallel between their path and yours. If they started as an SDR, mention your BDR start. If they built a side hustle, reference yours. Find common ground.

04

Make the Ask

Request exactly 15 minutes. Not "some time" or "whenever you're free." Be specific. Make it easy to say yes.

The goal of Email 1 isn't to get hired. It's to get a response. You're planting a seed that says "this person actually did their homework and might be worth talking to." That's it. Don't try to close the deal in the first message.

Email 2: The Internal Validation

Subject: Re: BDR → VP Journey + Extreme Ownership

Hey Mike,

Quick follow up - I reached out to Bob [Last Name] on your team to learn more about Everstage and how you're building the sales org. Great conversation.

He mentioned one of the challenges right now is educating RevOps leaders who are still using spreadsheets for commission tracking and don't see it as a priority pain point yet.

I ran into this exact problem at [Previous Company] when we were selling [similar product]. What worked for us was building a "cost of manual comp admin" calculator that showed Finance and RevOps leaders they were spending 40+ hours per month on something that should take 2 hours. Changed the conversation from "nice to have" to "how fast can we implement."

Not sure if you're actively hiring, but attaching my resume in case it's helpful. Would still love to chat even if timing isn't right on your end - always down to talk shop with someone who came up the same way.

Best, [Your Name]

[Attach Resume]

Email 2 Breakdown: Why Internal Validation Wins



The Power Move

You talked to someone on their team. This is **massive**. It shows initiative, resourcefulness, and that you're serious enough to do actual research beyond LinkedIn stalking.

Most candidates never do this. By mentioning Bob by name, you've instantly separated yourself from 95% of applicants.

Problem-Solution Framing

You're not saying "hire me because I'm great." You're saying "I've solved this exact problem before, here's how." That's consultant-level positioning.

You're thinking like someone already on the team, not someone begging for an interview.

Timing Note: Send this 3-5 days after Email 1. Give them time to see the first message, but don't wait so long they forget who you are. This follow-up should feel natural, not desperate.

How to Execute the Multi-Threading Strategy

Find Team Members

Use LinkedIn to identify 2-3 people on the team. Look for AEs, SDRs, or other sales leaders. Avoid going straight to HR—they're gatekeepers, not decision makers.

Reach Out Genuinely

Message them saying you're researching the company and want to learn about their experience. Don't mention you're job hunting yet. Just ask questions about the product, team culture, and challenges.

Take Notes

Pay attention to pain points they mention. These become ammunition for Email 2. If Bob says "we're struggling with X," you reference that specific challenge in your follow-up.

This isn't manipulation—it's doing your homework. Sales leaders respect candidates who understand their business challenges before the first interview. By the time you send Email 2, you're not a stranger anymore. You're someone who's already invested time understanding their world.

Email 3: The Brag Book + Pipeline Play

Subject: Pipeline > Panic Hiring

Hey Mike,

I know you're slammed, so I'll keep this short.

Been thinking more about Everstage and the RevOps/Finance buyer personas. I've sold to both extensively at [Company] - know the pain points, the objections, the buying committee dynamics. Would love to just learn from you about how you're approaching the market.

Attaching a brag book with some case studies and results from my last two roles. Not sure if you're hiring right now, but in my experience leading teams, having a pipeline of really good candidates for when you need someone is always better than having to wait for HR 😊

Even if there's no immediate fit, I'd appreciate 15 minutes to pick your brain. Let's chat.

Best, [Your Name]

[Attach Brag Book]

Email 3 Strategy: Lower Pressure, Higher Value

Acknowledge Reality

"I know you're slammed" shows emotional intelligence. You're not assuming they have time. This lowers resistance and makes them more likely to engage.

Demonstrate Market Knowledge

You're talking about ICPs and buyer personas like you're already on the team. This isn't candidate language—it's peer-to-peer conversation.

Pipeline Play

This is genius. You're not asking for a job today. You're positioning yourself as someone they want in their back pocket for when they do need to hire. This bypasses HR timelines completely.

Brag Book Attachment

Not just a resume. Case studies, metrics, testimonials, before/after screenshots. Make it visual and easy to digest in 2 minutes.

Send this 5-7 days after Email 2. By now, you've established credibility through research and internal validation. This email reinforces that you're not desperate—you're strategic.

How to Build a Brag Book That Gets You Hired

Metrics That Matter

Don't just say "exceeded quota." Show the number: 127% of \$2M quota. Include year-over-year growth, deal velocity improvements, or win rate increases.

Social Proof

Include testimonials from managers, peers, or customers. One sentence from a VP saying "best hire I ever made" is worth more than a page of self-description.

Case Studies

Pick 2-3 wins. Show the problem, your approach, and the result. Make it visual with charts or screenshots if possible.

Your brag book should be 3-5 pages maximum. Hiring managers don't have time to read a novel. Use bullet points, visuals, and white space. Every page should answer the question: "Why should I hire this person?" If it doesn't directly support that answer, cut it.

Email 4: The Graceful Persistence

Subject: Timing might be off, but staying in touch

Hey Mike,

Obviously this might not be a priority right now, totally get it.

But I wanted to reach back out because every time I see Everstage content or talk to people in the RevOps space, I keep thinking: I could sell the shit out of this product.

Whether it's 3 months from now or 6 months from now, I'd love to stay in touch. Built my career selling complex tools to skeptical buyers - and commission software to finance leaders is exactly that kind of sale.

If nothing else, happy to be a resource if you ever need someone to gut-check positioning or talk through a deal. No strings attached.

Best, [Your Name]

Email 4 Breakdown: Graceful Persistence

Acknowledge the Silence

By Email 4, if they haven't responded, they're either not interested or legitimately swamped. This email gives them an out while keeping the door open.

"Obviously this might not be a priority" shows you're not bitter or pushy. You get it. Sales leaders appreciate that maturity.

The "happy to be a resource" line is pure gold. You're offering value even if there's no job. This positions you as generous and confident, not needy. Some of the best hires happen because someone stayed in touch and offered help before asking for anything in return.

Send this 7-10 days after Email 3. After Email 4, stop. Move them to quarterly check-ins or drop them entirely. Respect the silence.

Genuine Enthusiasm

"I could sell the shit out of this product" is confident without being arrogant. It's enthusiasm, not desperation. There's a difference.

This line tells them you're not just looking for any job—you're specifically interested in what they're building.

What Happens After Email 4

No Response After 4 Emails

Move to quarterly check-ins. Send a brief message every 3 months with a relevant article, congrats on a company milestone, or a simple "still interested if timing works out." Stay on their radar without being annoying.

They Want to Talk

Congratulations, the sequence worked. Now don't blow it. Treat the call like a discovery conversation, not a job interview. Ask about challenges, team structure, and how they measure success. Position yourself as a peer consultant, not a desperate candidate.

1

2

3

They Respond But No Current Opening

Ask to stay in touch. Request permission to check in monthly. Offer to be helpful—send relevant content, introduce them to potential customers, or share market insights. Build the relationship now, get hired later.

The Execution Checklist: Don't Skip These

1

Space Emails Properly

Don't send all 4 emails in one week. Give each message 5-7 days to breathe. Desperation moves fast. Strategy moves deliberately.

2

Actually Talk to Team Members

Email 2 only works if you genuinely had that conversation. Don't fake the Bob reference. Multi-threading requires real effort.

3

Make the Brag Book Visual

Not just a resume. Include metrics, testimonials, screenshots, and case studies. Make it scannable in 2 minutes.

4

Track Everything

Spreadsheet with contact name, company, email dates, responses, next actions. Treat this like a sales pipeline because that's exactly what it is.

5

Adapt Your Research

These templates are examples. Do your own homework for each target. Generic emails get deleted. Specific research gets responses.

Common Mistakes That Kill This Strategy

Sending Generic Versions

If you can replace the hiring manager's name with anyone else's and the email still works, it's too generic. Every sentence should be customized based on real research. Copy-paste will get you copy-paste results: nothing.

Skipping the Multi-Threading

Email 2 loses all its power if you didn't actually talk to Bob. Don't fake internal validation—it's obvious and kills your credibility instantly. Do the work or skip Email 2 entirely.

Sending All 4 Too Fast

If you blast through all 4 emails in 10 days, you look desperate. Patience is part of the strategy. Give each email time to land. Sales leaders respect discipline, not urgency.

Making It About You

Nobody cares that you're "passionate" or "eager to learn." They care about whether you can solve their problems. Frame every email around their challenges, not your needs.

Why This Sequence Works When Others Fail



You Control the Narrative

Instead of waiting for HR to call you back, you're driving the conversation. You're positioning yourself as a peer, not a supplicant. That psychological shift changes everything.



Social Proof at Every Step

Email 1 shows research. Email 2 shows you talked to the team. Email 3 shows results. Email 4 shows persistence without desperation. By the end, you've demonstrated every quality good salespeople have.



Progressive Value Building

Each email adds more context and credibility. You're not asking for everything upfront. You're building a case systematically, the same way you'd nurture a sales opportunity.

The candidates who get hired aren't always the most qualified. They're the ones who make the hiring manager's job easiest. This sequence does exactly that—it gives them all the information they need to say yes, wrapped in a package that shows you already think like someone on their team.

Your Next Steps: Execute This Week

1

Identify 10 Target Companies

Pick companies where you'd genuinely want to work. Research the sales leaders. Find their content, career history, and leadership philosophy. Write it down.

2

Build Your Brag Book

Pull together case studies, metrics, testimonials, and proof of results. Make it visual. Get it to 3-5 pages. This is your ammunition for Email 3.

3

Find Team Members to Multi-Thread

For each target company, identify 2-3 people on the team. Reach out to learn about the company. Take notes on challenges they mention.

4

Send Email 1 This Week

Pick your top 3 targets. Customize Email 1 for each. Send them this week. Track the responses. Adjust based on what works.

5

Set Up Your Tracking System

Build a spreadsheet with columns for contact name, company, email dates, responses, and next actions. Update it after every interaction.

Most job seekers will read this and do nothing. They'll save it, tell themselves they'll execute "next week," and keep sending the same generic applications that get ignored. Don't be most job seekers. The sequence only works if you actually use it. Send Email 1 to three people this week. Track the results. Adjust and repeat. This isn't theory—it's a proven playbook that works when you execute it with discipline and precision.